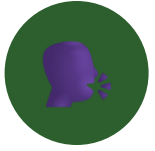




Pronouns in Context

Discovering the Rules for Ourselves

A2 English Class



Spot the Problem

Listen and react — how does this sound?

"Mr. Rahman is a teacher. Mr. Rahman's wife is a doctor. Mr. Rahman and Mr. Rahman's wife have two children. Mr. Rahman's children go to Mr. Rahman's school. Mr. Rahman's school is very big."

What's strange about this paragraph?



New Words

Word	Meaning
paddled	moved the boat using a paddle
calm	still, quiet (no waves or wind)
hikers	people who walk in nature for fun
storm	very foul weather with strong wind and rain
kindness	being kind and helpful to someone



A Weekend Trip to Green Lake

Part 1 of 2 — read for the story

Last Saturday, **my** friend Amina and **I** went camping at Green Lake with **her** family. Amina's parents have a small boat, and **they** let **us** use **it** in the morning. **We** paddled **it ourselves** because **nobody** else wanted to join **us**. The lake was calm, and the water looked like glass — **this** made the whole trip feel relaxing.

Around noon, **we** met a group of hikers **who** were walking around the lake. One woman, **whose** dog kept following **her**, stopped to talk to **us**. "Is **this your** boat?" **she** asked. "Yes, **it's ours**," **I** answered. "**My** friend's parents bought **it** for **us** last year." The woman smiled and told **us** something funny about **her** own boat, **which she** had lost in a storm.



A Weekend Trip to Green Lake

Part 2 of 2 — read for the story

That was such a sad story, but *she* laughed about *it* *herself*.

That evening, *everybody* sat around the fire and told stories. *Someone* brought a guitar, and *we* all sang songs together. There wasn't *anywhere* quiet to sleep because the group next to *us* was noisy, but *we* didn't mind. Amina and *I* shared a tent, and *we* kept *ourselves* warm with two blankets.

In the morning, *we* packed *our* things and thanked the woman for *her* kindness. *It* had been a wonderful weekend, and *that* is a memory *I* will never forget.



Understanding the Story

Answer in full sentences

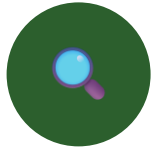
- Where did Amina and the writer go?
- What did they do in the morning?
- Who did they meet at the lake?
- What happened around the fire that night?
- Did the writer enjoy the weekend? How do you know?



True or False?

Find the sentence that proves your answer

- The writer went camping alone.
- They had to use the boat by themselves.
- The woman they met lost her boat in a storm.
- They slept in a quiet place.
- The writer didn't enjoy the trip.



Detective Colours

Highlight these word types in the story



Personal pronoun — subject

I, we, they, she, it



Personal pronoun — object

us, it, her



Possessive

my, her, your, ours



Demonstrative

this, that



Relative

who, whose, which



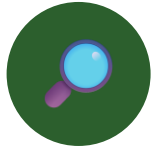
Reflexive

ourselves, herself



Indefinite

nobody, everybody, someone, anywhere



Look Closely — Part 1

- BLUE: What noun does each blue word replace? Where does it sit — before or after the verb?

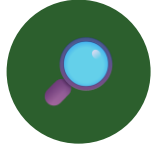
- Personal nouns - Before the verb

- LIGHT BLUE: Where do these words sit? Compare "us" and "we" — same people, different word. Why?

- After the verb – We is Subjective and Us is Objective

- GREEN: Is there always a noun right after the green word? Compare "her family" with "ours."

- Yes, but if we add 's', then there will be no nouns.



Look Closely — Part 2

- ORANGE: Find "this" and "that." Does each point to one object, or to a whole situation?

- Sometimes one object, other time whole situation.

- PURPLE: What kind of noun comes right before "who"? Before "which"? What does "whose" show?

- Before who: person, before which: object. Whose show a connection.

- RED: In "we kept ourselves warm," who does the action and who receives it?

- The same person.

- GOLD: Sort nobody / everybody / someone / anywhere. Do we know exactly who or where?

- We do not.

A

Group A — Personal Pronouns & Repetition

Examples from the story

Amina's parents have a small boat, and they let us use it.

We paddled it ourselves because nobody else wanted to join us.

Discussion questions

- If we didn't use "they," what word would repeat?
- Sort the pronouns: which do the action? Which receive the action?
- Write your rule: Subject pronouns are used when **they are before the verb**. Object pronouns are used when **they are after the verb**.

B Group B — Possessive Adjectives vs. Possessive Pronouns

Examples from the story

“her family”

“your boat”

“My friend’s parents”

“it’s ours”

Discussion questions

- Is there always a noun directly after the word? After possessive adjective: Yes. After possessive pronoun: No.
- Write your rule: A possessive adjective is used + noun when the ‘s’ is missing. A possessive pronoun stands alone when there is an ‘s’.

C

Group C — Demonstrative Pronouns

Examples from the story

“this made the whole trip feel relaxing”

“That was such a sad story”

“Is this your boat?”

“that is a memory I will never forget”

Discussion questions

- Which example point to one nearby object? *“Is this your boat?”*
- Which point to a whole idea from before? *“this made the whole trip feel relaxing”*

D

Group D — Relative Pronouns

Examples from the story

“a group of hikers who were walking”

“a woman, whose dog kept following her”

“her own boat, which she had lost in a storm”

Discussion questions

- Which word is used for people? (Who) Which for things? (Which) Which shows connection? (Whose)
- Write your rule: who = for people whose = for a connection which = for object

E

Group E — Reflexive Pronouns

Examples from the story

“We paddled it ourselves”

“she laughed about it herself”

“we kept ourselves warm”

Discussion questions

- What letters do these words end in? Self or Selves.
- How do they match the subject (we → ourselves, she → herself)?
- Write your rule: Use a reflexive pronoun when the subject does the work itself and put an extra importance.

F

Group F — Indefinite Pronouns

Examples from the story

“nobody else wanted to join us”

“someone brought a guitar”

“everybody sat around the fire”

“there wasn't anywhere quiet to sleep”

Discussion questions

- Sort the words: people, places. Do we know exactly who or where? - No
- Write your rule: -body/-one = for people -where = for place -thing = for idea or object



Practice: Choose the Right Word

1. Sarah is my neighbor. ____ (She/Her) is very friendly.
2. I saw Tom yesterday. I gave ____ (he/him) my book.
3. This is not my bag. It's ____ (her/hers).
4. ____ (This/These) shoes are too small for me.
5. The man ____ (who/which) lives next door is a doctor.
6. I use my brother's car — ____ (whose/which) is very old.
7. The children hurt ____ (them/themselves) playing football.
8. ____ (Somebody/Something) left a message on the table.
9. She ____ (go/goes) to the gym every morning.
10. My parents ____ (doesn't/don't) like loud music.



Answers

1. She

2. him

3. hers

4. These

5. who

6. which

7. themselves

8. Somebody / Someone

9. goes

10. don't



Practice: Rewrite the Sentences

Replace repeated nouns with pronouns

1. Maria is a teacher. Maria's students love Maria.
2. I met a woman. The woman's dog was very friendly.
3. This is John's phone. This phone is not mine.
4. My brother made breakfast. My brother made it for my brother.
5. I have two dogs. I love the dogs.



Sample Answers

1. Maria is a teacher. Her students love her.
2. I met a woman whose dog was very friendly.
3. This phone is John's — it's his, not mine.
4. My brother made breakfast for himself.
5. I have two dogs. I love them.



Practice: Find and Fix the Error

1. Her is my best friend.
2. This are my keys.
3. They doesn't like coffee.
4. I hurt me when I fell.
5. Is this pen you?



Answers

1. She is my best friend.
2. These are my keys.
3. They don't like coffee.
4. I hurt myself when I fell.
5. Is this pen yours?



Quick Quiz

Answer as fast as you can!

- What's the object pronoun for "they"?
- "This" or "these" for one book?
- Which relative pronoun do we use for people?
- What does "themselves" show?
- She ____ (like) tea.



Reference Chart: Personal, Possessive & Reflexive

Person	Subject	Object	Possessive Adj.	Possessive Pron.	Reflexive
I	I	me	my	mine	myself
You (sg.)	you	you	your	yours	yourself
He	he	him	his	his	himself
She	she	her	her	hers	herself
It	it	it	its	—	itself
We	we	us	our	ours	ourselves
You (pl.)	you	you	your	yours	yourselves
They	they	them	their	theirs	themselves



Reference Chart: Demonstrative, Relative & Indefinite

Demonstrative

this — singular, near

that — singular, far

these — plural, near

those — plural, far

* Can also point back to a whole idea: "That was a great story."

Relative

who — people, subject

whom — people, object
(formal)

whose — possession

which — things

that — people or things
(informal)

Indefinite

people → -body / -one

(somebody, everyone,
nobody)

things → -thing

(something, nothing)

places → -where

(somewhere, nowhere)



Homework: Your Own Weekend Diary

Write 100–120 words about a real or imagined weekend. Underline each one you use.

- ✓ At least 3 personal pronouns (subject and object)
- ✓ At least 2 possessive forms
- ✓ At least 1 demonstrative pronoun
- ✓ At least 1 relative pronoun
- ✓ At least 1 reflexive pronoun
- ✓ At least 1 indefinite pronoun
- ✓ Correct subject–verb agreement throughout